

# BALAAJEE VR


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LinkedIn Profile


## PORTFOLIO & WORKS

Design Gallery (Behance)

## EDUCATION

**B.E. Information Technology**
MS University • 2004

## TEACHING & PRACTICE AREAS

### DESIGN STUDIO & SYSTEMS

- Human-Centered Design (HCD)
- Enterprise Design Systems
- Cognitive Ergonomics & Usability
- Design Thinking & Sprint Studios
- AI-Augmented UX Workflows

### MENTORSHIP & PEDAGOGY

- Industry Capstone Mentorship
- Studio Critiques & Portfolio Reviews
- Design Sprints & Workshops
- Global Hackathons & Contests

### INSTITUTIONAL SYNERGY

- Industry-Academia MoUs
- Design Internship & Placements
- Corporate R&D Sponsorships

## TECHNOLOGY & AI STACK

**AI & Automation:** IBM Watson, MS Copilot, ChatGPT Enterprise, Google Stitch, NotebookLM, AI Studio

**Design & Prototyping:** Figma, Miro, Mural, Design Tokens, FigJam

**Research & Usability:** UserTesting, Hotjar, Google Analytics, Heuristic Analysis

## AWARDS & RECOGNITION

**Samsung:** 10-Year US Business Visa for driving global healthcare UX research.

**Ericsson:** Spot Award for sustaining UX innovation culture.

**Ericsson:** 1st Place, Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest.

**Product Impact:** Designed "Greedy Jump" iOS app (80K+ downloads).

PRODUCT DESIGN EXECUTIVE

# 18+ Years

Building world-class design organizations & systems

| 50+ | 5 | 1.5 Yrs |
|---|---|---|
| MENTORED | TECH GIANTS | TEACHING |

## ACADEMIC & PROFESSIONAL STATEMENT

Accomplished Design Executive with 18+ years of industry leadership directing global design organizations across IBM, Zebra Technologies, Ericsson, Samsung, and Infosys. Supported by a foundational B.E. in Information Technology (MS University) and prior Anna University affiliated engineering college teaching experience. Seeking to serve as Professor of Practice at VIT School of Design (V-SIGN) to cultivate industry-ready design professionals. Proven track record of instituting studio-based critique cultures, governing enterprise design systems, conducting generative user research, and integrating AI-UX interaction models. Committed to bridging academic curricula with real-world practice, guiding multidisciplinary capstones, and fostering strategic industry partnerships.

## INDUSTRY PRACTICE & DESIGN LEADERSHIP

### UI/UX Design — Senior Manager
Sep 2024 – Jan 2026
IBM Software Labs

- Orchestrated a UX team re-organization, transitioning 12 designers into a centralized UX-as-a-Service studio model to optimize talent allocation and foster cross-functional design collaboration across global product portfolios.
- Mentored and upskilled design staff in integrating cutting-edge AI tools (Watson, GenAI) into day-to-day creative workflows, establishing structured frameworks for AI-assisted prototyping and interaction design.
- Architected AI-UX interaction models for IBM Watson across Rhapsody SE and MaaS360, translating complex engineering protocols into intuitive, user-centric enterprise interfaces.
- Conducted portfolio-wide UX governance workshops, institutionalizing design heuristics and accessibility standards to mitigate deployment risks in mission-critical environments.

### UI/UX Product Design Manager
Jul 2021 – Aug 2024
Zebra Technologies

- Directed a multi-disciplinary UI/UX team spanning B2B hardware and enterprise software portfolios; served as primary Hiring & Mentorship Manager, coaching designers from entry-level to senior roles.
- Championed Lean UX methodologies and facilitated studio-based design sprint workshops, establishing a proactive, generative research culture across engineering squads.
- Governed scalable design system standards across distributed product lines, codifying UI component libraries to ensure visual consistency and accelerate cross-functional handoffs.

### UI/UX Senior Specialist
Oct 2020 – Jul 2021
ZF Wabco

- Spearheaded UX strategy for mission-critical automotive infotainment and telematics, applying cognitive ergonomics and user research to driver-safety interfaces.
- Mentored junior designers on data-informed design decisions and scaled enterprise UI component libraries across global product squads.

### UI/UX Designer
Jul 2019 – Sep 2020
Ericsson Global

- Won 1st Place in Ericsson Global Hack-fest Optimization Contest and earned Spot Award for fostering collaborative design innovation and workshop culture.
- Architected and standardized the Ericsson Design System, aligning design patterns with global engineering implementation.

### Lead UI/UX Designer
Sep 2017 – Jul 2019
NP Compete Technologies

- Directed end-to-end design cycles, managing design sprints and mentoring junior designers in usability testing, interactive wireframing, and design heuristics.

## EARLIER EXPERIENCE

- **Creative Head** — Titi Technologies — May 2010 – Apr 2015
- **Senior Software Engineer** — Infosys Technologies — Jan 2006 – Apr 2010
- **Lecturer (IT)** — SKR Engg. College (Anna Univ. Affiliated) — May 2005 – Jan 2006
- **Teaching Faculty** — Computer Science & IT Department — Aug 2004 – Mar 2005

**Design Contests:** 1st Place in MockingBOT & UP Labs UX Challenges.